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INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY POLICY

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Policy Number: IT-001
Policy Title: Acceptable Use Policy
Effective Date: January 1, 2026
Review Date: January 1, 2027
Owner: Information Technology Department

PURPOSE

This policy establishes the acceptable use of information technology resources at GlobalTech Corporation to ensure security, productivity, and compliance with laws and regulations.

SCOPE

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, and third-party users who access GlobalTech IT resources.

GENERAL PRINCIPLES

Authorized Use

IT resources are provided for business purposes only. Incidental personal use is permitted if it:

- Does not interfere with work responsibilities
- Does not consume significant resources
- Does not violate other policies or laws
- Is not for commercial purposes

Security

Users must:

- Protect their passwords and authentication credentials
- Lock workstations when unattended
- Report security incidents immediately
- Follow all security procedures

Privacy

Users should have no expectation of privacy when using company IT resources. The company reserves the right to monitor, audit, and inspect IT resources.

COMPUTER USE

Hardware

- Company computers are for business use only
- Users must not modify hardware configurations without IT approval
- Report hardware issues to IT Help Desk
- Protect equipment from damage and theft

Software

- Only install software approved by IT
- Software licenses must be properly maintained
- Do not use pirated or unauthorized software
- Report software needs to IT for proper procurement

System Configuration

- Do not modify system settings without IT approval
- Keep systems updated with security patches
- Do not disable security features
- Follow IT configuration standards

NETWORK AND INTERNET USE

Internet Access

- Internet access is provided for business purposes
- Personal use should be minimal and incidental
- Do not access inappropriate or illegal content
- Bandwidth-intensive personal use is prohibited

Wi-Fi and Remote Access

- Use only authorized Wi-Fi networks
- VPN required for remote access
- Do not share remote access credentials
- Report connectivity issues to IT

Network Security

- Do not attempt to bypass network security controls
- Do not connect unauthorized devices to the network
- Report suspicious network activity
- Follow network access procedures

EMAIL AND COMMUNICATION

Email Use

- Use email for business communication
- Professional tone and content required
- Do not send confidential information without encryption
- Report phishing attempts to IT

Instant Messaging

- Use approved messaging platforms for business

- Maintain professional communication standards
- Do not share sensitive information via unapproved channels
- Archive business communications appropriately

Social Media

- Personal social media use during work hours should be minimal
- Do not represent the company online without authorization
- Protect confidential information in social media posts
- Follow company social media guidelines

DATA AND INFORMATION

Data Classification

- Handle data according to its classification level
- Protect confidential and sensitive information
- Follow data retention and disposal policies
- Report data breaches immediately

Data Storage

- Store company data on approved systems only
- Do not store company data on personal devices
- Follow backup procedures for critical data
- Do not use unauthorized cloud storage services

Data Sharing

- Share data only with authorized recipients
- Use secure methods for data transmission
- Verify recipient authorization before sharing
- Follow data sharing procedures

MOBILE DEVICES

Company-Issued Devices

- Protect devices from loss and theft
- Keep devices updated with security patches
- Report lost or stolen devices immediately
- Use only approved applications

Personal Devices

- Personal device use for business requires IT approval
- Mobile Device Management (MDM) enrollment required
- Company data can be wiped from personal devices
- No expectation of privacy on personal devices used for business

BYOD Policy

Bring Your Own Device is permitted with:

- IT approval and MDM enrollment
- Acceptable use agreement signed
- Security requirements met

- Company data separation maintained

SECURITY COMPLIANCE

Password Management

- Use strong passwords (minimum 12 characters, mixed case, numbers, symbols)
- Change passwords every 90 days
- Do not share passwords with anyone
- Use unique passwords for different systems

Multi-Factor Authentication

- MFA required for remote access
- MFA required for sensitive systems
- Register approved authentication devices
- Report MFA issues to IT

Security Incidents

- Report all security incidents immediately
- Do not attempt to resolve security incidents personally
- Cooperate with security investigations
- Follow incident response procedures

PROHIBITED ACTIVITIES

The following activities are strictly prohibited:

- Unauthorized access to systems or data
- Use of IT resources for illegal activities
- Introduction of malware or malicious code
- Circumvention of security controls
- Unauthorized monitoring of network traffic
- Harassment or discrimination via IT resources
- Commercial use of company IT resources
- Disclosure of confidential information
- Violation of software licenses
- Interference with others' use of IT resources

ENFORCEMENT

Policy Violations

- Violations may result in disciplinary action
- Serious violations may result in termination
- Illegal activities will be reported to authorities
- Users may be liable for damages caused

Monitoring

- IT systems are monitored for security purposes

- Usage may be audited for compliance
- No expectation of privacy on company systems
- Monitoring follows applicable laws and regulations

REPORTING

Security Incidents

Report security incidents to:

IT Security: security@globaltech.com

Phone: 555-0999 (24/7)

Policy Questions

Contact IT Department for policy questions:

IT Help Desk: helpdesk@globaltech.com

Phone: 555-0199

Policy Violations

Report policy violations to:

Human Resources: hr@globaltech.com

IT Security: security@globaltech.com

POLICY ACKNOWLEDGMENT

I acknowledge that I have read and understand the Acceptable Use Policy. I agree to comply with all provisions of this policy and understand that violations may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Signature: _____

Employee Name: _____

Employee ID: _____

Date: _____

For questions about this policy, contact the IT Department.